

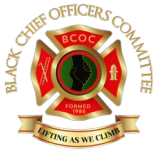
BYLAWS

BLACK CHIEF OFFICERS COMMITTEE

Proposed new/edits shown in blue. Original 2017 language shown in red.

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ARTICLE I - NAME (Adopted 1993)

The organization is a standing committee of the International Association of Black Professional Firefighters (IABPFF) and shall be named the Black Chief Officers' Committee, hereafter referred to as "BCOC".

ARTICLE II - PURPOSE (Adopted 1993)

The "BCOC" is a membership organization formed to provide unique resources to Black Fire Executives to enhance their ability to better serve the public and the firefighting profession. The BCOC shall exercise leadership in the development of minorities in public and private management positions; sponsor forums for discussion of timely issues and topical concerns; support the development and maintenance of a repository of Black Executive talent for job openings and technical assistance.

Section I: Directives

- a) To serve as a resource to the members of the IABPFF and assist in providing mentoring to the organization's leadership.
- b) To assist our Black brothers and sisters in securing appointments as chief officers as well as other advancements within the fire service.
- c) To represent the IABPFF at all Chief Officer functions when appropriate and necessary.
- d) To promote unity between Chief Officers and other members of the IABPFF.
- e) To continue to be active participants within the IABPFF.
- f) To provide a viable and valuable conduit between the IABPFF and the IAFC.

Section II: Functions

- a) To identify and respond to issues within the fire service that affect Black firefighters and Black Communities, which merit attention, inquiry or investigation.
- b) To provide a forum for discussion of issues which affect Black firefighters and the fire service.
- c) To develop recommendations for corrective action to resolve issues that affect Black firefighters.
- d) To provide resources which enhance the upward mobility of Blacks in the fire service.



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- e) To develop an effective network of information on promotional opportunities for Black Firefighters.

ARTICLE III - MEMBERSHIP (Adopted 1993; Amended 2015)

Membership is open to any person holding the rank of Chief Officer in a paid fire organization, and a member of a local affiliate or independent member of the IABPFF (if one exists) and is financially current with regards to applicable dues.

Section 1: Categories (Adopted 1993; Amended 2015)

- a) **Individual Membership:** Open to all Chief Fire Officers who subscribe to the goals and objectives of the organization.
- b) **Associate Membership:** Open to all professional associations, organizations and institutions, public and private, which subscribe to the goals and objectives of the BCOC and especially wish to help promote equal opportunities for all minorities.
- c) **Corporate Membership:** Open to all private organizations, which subscribe to the goals and objectives of the BCOC.
- e) **Retired Membership:** Open to any BCOC member who, at the time of separation, without prejudice, from a paid fire organization, was a member in good standing, is eligible for retired membership.
- f) **Affiliate Membership:** Open to all non-chief officers of fire rescue, EMS and communications department personnel who subscribe to the goals and objectives of the organization.
- g) **Only Individual and Retired Membership** are eligible to vote.

ARTICLE IV - OFFICERS (Adopted 1993; Amended 2015, 2017, Proposed Changes 2026)



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1. The ~~officers~~ **Executive Board** of the BCOC shall consist of a Chair~~person~~, Vice-Chair~~person~~, Recording Secretary, Correspondence Secretary, Treasurer, Financial Secretary, Parliamentarian and the immediate past Chair~~person~~.
2. These elected officers shall constitute the makeup of the BCOC Executive Board hereafter referred to as the Executive Board.
3. **Officers of the BCOC shall consist of the Parliamentarian, Educational Coordinator, Chaplain and the Public Information Officer**
3. At least five (5) Board Members are required for a quorum.

Section 1: Chair~~person~~ (Adopted 1993)

- a) The Chair~~person~~ shall preside at all meetings of the BCOC and Executive Board and perform all the duties pertaining to the office of the Chair~~person~~. Appoint Regional Coordinators, BCOC committees and other staff assignments as prescribed by the Executive Board. In addition, he/she shall perform those duties that may be prescribed by the BCOC and bring such matters to the attention of the Executive Board.
- b) The Chair~~person~~ shall represent the BCOC at official functions and in activities or deliberations which require BCOC representation.
- c) The Chair~~person~~ shall approve official BCOC announcements, statements and correspondence when in the Chairperson's opinion, such documents accurately reflect the consensus opinion of the BCOC.
- d) The Chair~~person~~ shall accept volunteers or appoint members to BCOC committees as necessary. Additionally, the Chair~~person~~ shall receive reports, proposals, and minutes of BCOC committees for transmittal to the membership.
- e) The Chair, with the concurrence of the Vice-Chair, may appoint individuals to the following non-voting positions to support the operations and mission of the BCOC.
- f) Appointed position holders shall serve non-voting, advisory roles and shall have no authority to cast votes on any Executive Board or membership matter unless they separately hold an elected office.
- g) Terms of appointment shall align with the term of the seated Chair. When a new Chair assumes office, all appointed positions under this Article shall be vacated and subject to reappointment. Where election cycles permit, appointments shall align with the staggered election schedule set forth in Article V, Section 1.



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- h) Appointed individuals shall be members of the BCOC in good standing. The Chair may remove an appointed position holder at any time with notice to the Vice-Chair.
- i) Each appointed position holder shall submit a brief written report to the Executive Board no less than twice per year, summarizing activities, progress, and upcoming plans within their area of responsibility.

Section 2: Vice Chairperson (Adopted 1993)

- a) The Vice-Chairperson shall act for the Chairperson when the Chairperson is unable to attend BCOC meetings, Executive Board meetings or a function where BCOC representation is required or desired.
- b) Additionally, the Vice-Chairperson shall serve as coordinator of appointed committees, keep a calendar of all committee meetings (Executive, standing, etc.) and perform such other duties as may be prescribed by the Chairperson.

Section 3: Recording Secretary (Adopted 1993)

- a) The Recording Secretary shall keep minutes of regular meetings, as directed by the Chairperson, and shall disseminate minutes of BCOC meetings to the Membership.
- b) The Recording Secretary shall assist in identifying and selecting material relevant to proposed agenda items, and shall collaborate with the Correspondence Secretary in disseminating such material to all members prior to BCOC meetings.
- c) In addition, as necessary, the Recording Secretary shall assist the Correspondence Secretary in notifying the membership of meetings and perform all duties pertaining to the office, or as prescribed by the Chairperson.

Section 4: Correspondence Secretary (Adopted 1993)

- a) The Corresponding Secretary shall send written notice of regular and called meetings and conduct the correspondence of the BCOC.
- b) The Correspondence Secretary shall assist the Recording Secretary in gathering and preparing materials relevant to BCOC meetings.

Section 5: Parliamentarian (Adopted 1993)



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- a) The Parliamentarian shall have the responsibility for ensuring that meetings are conducted in accordance with parliamentary procedures as outlined in Robert's Rules of Order.
- b) Additionally, the Parliamentarian shall prepare the BCOC for silent meditation at the beginning of each meeting.

Section 6: Treasurer (Adopted 1993; Amended 2017)

- a) The Treasurer shall be held accountable for all monies due and in receipt of the organization. The Treasurer shall also be responsible for the accurate disbursement of funds owed by the BCOC.
- b) All checks, drafts, payments of money or evidence of indebtedness, issued in the name of the organization, shall be signed by the Treasurer and either the Chairperson or his/her designee. The designee must be a Board member. The Board retains the authority to designate an institution(s) for the deposit of funds of the organization.

2017 language:

- ~~c) The Treasurer shall ensure an external annual financial statement and audit report is prepared within thirty (30) days of the end of the fiscal year. The external auditor shall be approved by the Executive Board.~~ The Chair shall ensure an external annual financial statement and audit report is prepared within thirty (30) days of the end of the fiscal year. Selection of the independent auditor or auditing firm shall be governed by Section 6(i) and 6(j) of this Article.
- d) The Treasurer shall maintain accurate financial records of all revenues, expenditures, deposits, and disbursements of the organization in accordance with sound financial management practices.
- e) The Treasurer shall provide a quarterly financial report to the Executive Board outlining revenues, expenditures, account balances, and any outstanding financial obligations.
- f) The Treasurer shall present an annual financial summary to the membership during the annual conference outlining the financial condition of the organization. This report shall be delivered electronically in PDF format or as a slide presentation (e.g., PowerPoint or equivalent) and distributed to all members no fewer than seven (7) days prior to the annual conference.



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- g) The organization shall undergo a financial audit at the close of each fiscal year.
- h) At the discretion of the Chairperson, an additional financial audit may be conducted when a new Chairperson assumes office.
- i) The selection of the independent auditor or auditing firm shall be conducted through the following process to ensure independence and objectivity: (1) A Finance and Audit Committee, consisting of no fewer than three (3) Executive Board members who are not the Chairperson or Treasurer, shall be convened by the Vice Chairperson at the start of each fiscal year; (2) The Finance and Audit Committee shall solicit, evaluate, and recommend a qualified independent auditor or auditing firm to the full Executive Board; (3) The Chairperson may submit a nomination for consideration by the Finance and Audit Committee, but shall not serve on the Committee or cast a vote in its deliberations; (4) The Executive Board shall approve the final selection by majority vote. No auditor or auditing firm with a pre-existing financial or personal relationship with the Chairperson or Treasurer shall be eligible for selection.
- j) Any Executive Board member who has a financial, professional, or personal relationship with a firm or individual under consideration for the audit engagement shall disclose that relationship to the Finance and Audit Committee and shall recuse themselves from all deliberations and votes related to that firm or individual. The Finance and Audit Committee shall document its selection process and present its recommendation to the full Executive Board prior to final approval.

Treasurer Qualifications:

- k) To be eligible to serve as Treasurer, a candidate must possess demonstrated knowledge of or experience in financial management, accounting, bookkeeping, or a related field. The Treasurer is not required to be a chief officer, active firefighter, or affiliated with a fire department. Prior professional experience in financial administration, public accounting, non-profit finance, government finance, or a comparable discipline is strongly preferred. The Executive Board may establish additional qualification criteria by written policy.
- l) The Treasurer shall maintain a centralized, electronic document repository accessible to all Executive Board members. This repository shall include, but is not limited to quarterly and annual financial reports, audit reports, IRS filings and returns, QuickBooks or equivalent accounting records, invoices, receipts, and records of all approved



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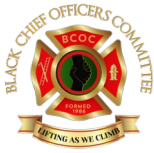
expenditures. Bank statements shall not be required in the shared repository but must be made available to any Executive Board member upon written request. The repository shall be maintained on a secure platform approved by the Executive Board and kept current within thirty (30) days of any filing or transaction period close.

Section 7: Financial Secretary (Amended 2015, 201, Proposed Changes 2026)

- a) The Financial Secretary shall be responsible for supervising the use of all assets of the Black Chief Officers' Committee (BCOC).
- b) The Financial Secretary shall ensure that all monies of the BCOC are deposited in proper accounts and that the BCOC is properly bonded.
- c) The Financial Secretary will keep record of all funds collected and dispersed by the Treasurer and that funds are collected, recorded, and disbursed according to accepted accounting principles and in accordance with the Bylaws of the BCOC and policies adopted by the Board.
- d) The Financial Secretary will report to the annual conference on the financial condition of the BCOC, including a summary of all revenues and disbursements.
- e) The Financial Secretary shall assist the Treasurer in gathering and preparing materials relevant to BCOC meetings.
- f) The Financial Secretary shall assist in ensuring financial accountability by maintaining records of funds collected and verifying deposits.
- g) The Financial Secretary shall coordinate with the Treasurer to ensure financial reports accurately reflect the financial condition of the organization.
- h) The Financial Secretary may assist the Executive Board in reviewing financial documentation to support transparency and responsible financial management.

Section 8: Educational Coordinator (Non-Voting; Appointed)

- a) The Educational Coordinator shall serve as the primary planner and coordinator for all educational programming offered by the BCOC, including the annual conference, training workshops, seminars, and virtual education sessions.



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- b) Responsibilities shall include: identifying relevant topics and speakers; coordinating logistics for in-person and virtual sessions; managing registration and attendance tracking for educational events; and working with the Marketing/Public Information Officer to promote programming to the membership and public.
- c) The Educational Coordinator shall develop and maintain an annual educational calendar and shall present a summary of planned programming to the Executive Board at the start of each calendar year.
- d) The Educational Coordinator shall coordinate with external organizations, academic institutions, and fire service agencies as appropriate to expand the BCOC's educational offerings and professional development opportunities.

Section 9: Public Information Officer (Non-Voting; Appointed)

- a) The Public Information Officer (PIO) shall be responsible for managing the BCOC's public image, communications strategy, and media relations. The PIO shall serve as the primary point of contact for all external media inquiries unless otherwise directed by the Chair.
- b) Responsibilities shall include managing the BCOC's social media accounts and website content; developing and distributing press releases, newsletters, and member communications; promoting BCOC events, programs, and initiatives; and maintaining a consistent and professional organizational brand.
- c) The PIO shall coordinate closely with the Corresponding Secretary, Educational Coordinator, and Chair to ensure timely and accurate dissemination of organizational information.
- d) All official public statements on behalf of the BCOC shall be reviewed and approved by the Chairperson prior to release.

Section 10: Corresponding Secretary (Voting; Elected)

- a) The Corresponding Secretary assists with the administrative correspondence functions of the organization, providing additional capacity when the elected Recording Secretary requires support or when the position is vacant.
- b) Responsibilities shall include drafting and sending written notices of meetings and events; maintaining an organized record of outgoing correspondence; and assisting the Recording Secretary in preparing and distributing meeting materials and member communications.



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Section 11: Chaplain (Non-Voting; Appointed)

- a) The Chaplain shall provide spiritual support, guidance, and pastoral care to BCOC members and shall assist in fostering a spirit of unity, reflection, and service within the organization.
- b) Responsibilities shall include opening each BCOC meeting and conference session with an invocation or moment of reflection; providing pastoral support to members experiencing personal or professional hardship; coordinating memorial tributes for deceased members; and assisting the Parliamentarian in opening meeting protocols where applicable.
- c) The Chaplain shall respect the diversity of religious beliefs and cultural backgrounds within the BCOC membership and shall conduct their duties in an inclusive and non-denominational manner unless otherwise requested by the presiding officer.

Section 12: Sergeant-at-Arms (Non-Voting; Appointed)

- a) The Sergeant-at-Arms shall be responsible for maintaining order and decorum at all BCOC meetings and events. The Sergeant-at-Arms shall be positioned at the entrance of all meetings and shall admit only those persons who are in good standing with the BCOC and have properly registered for the event.
- b) Responsibilities shall include verifying member credentials and registration at all meetings and the annual conference; assisting the presiding officer in enforcing meeting protocols and rules of order; managing the physical arrangement and security of the meeting space; and escorting disruptive or unauthorized individuals from proceedings when directed to do so by the Chair or Parliamentarian.
- c) The Sergeant-at-Arms shall coordinate with venue security as needed and shall report any significant incidents to the Chair promptly.
- d) The provisions of Article VII regarding attire and meeting protocols shall be enforced by the Sergeant-at-Arms under the direction of the Chair.

Section 13: Add-Hoc Committees (Non-Voting; Appointed)

- 1) Elections
- 2) Bylaws
- 3) Ethics



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4) Membership

ARTICLE V - ELECTION (Adopted 1993; Amended 2015, 2017, Proposed 2026)

Section 1: Time and Place (Adopted 1993; Amended 2015)

- a) Elections of the Chairperson, Recording Secretary, Financial Secretary, and Parliamentary shall take place in odd years.
- b) Elections of the Vice Chairperson, Treasurer and Correspondence Secretary shall take place in even years.
- c) Staggered odd and even elections shall become effective commencing with the 2017 Business year.



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Section 2: Mode of Election (Adopted 1993)

- a) The election of the officers of the BCOC shall be by blind ballot after direct nomination.
The nominee receiving the highest number of votes shall be declared elected by the presiding officers.
- b) If competing candidates receive an equal number of votes thereby creating a tie vote situation, the Executive Board will choose the winner on a majority vote of the Executive Board. This vote will be announced by the Chairperson.
- c) The Elections Committee will certify the "official results". "Official Results" of the vote will be presented to the membership. The candidate receiving the highest number of votes shall be elected to office.

Section 3: Term of Office (Adopted 1993)

- a) The term of office of the officers of the BCOC shall begin at the close of the regular annual session of the BCOC Meeting in which they were elected.
- b) Term of office for elected officers shall be limited to two (2) consecutive terms.

Section 4: Voting (Adopted 1993; Amended 2015)

A. Qualifications for receiving a ballot to cast votes at the BCOC Meeting shall be:

1. The member must be in good standing with the BCOC.
2. The member ~~must be duly registered for the meeting (payment of registration fee.)~~
His/her name must appear on the ~~roll~~ **spreadsheet or other database.** ~~of the Treasurer.~~
3. Ballot will be ~~passed by roll call only from the~~ **sent by the Elections Committee Chair or Committee Member in coordination with the electronic ballot systems representative.**
4. Each qualified member of the meeting will be entitled to one ~~and only one~~ vote.
5. Members in good standing, wishing to be elected to office, shall submit their name and the office being sought. They will submit a profile of their qualifications, and



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- their position statement (not to exceed 250 words) to the Chair of the Elections Committee in writing 30 days before the annual meeting. ~~before January 1st of the year they are seeking election.~~
6. Whenever a single candidate is nominated for any office the elections process will consist of automatic ratification by the Elections Committee after the election process. Executive Board Members must excuse themselves from voting under these circumstances if they are candidates for that position.
 7. Whenever there are two (2) or more candidates for any office, the Elections Committee shall conduct an election process which shall consist of individual membership voting at the annual meeting in addition to the use of proxy/absentee ballots.
 8. The Elections Committee shall ensure the integrity of the balloting process. The Elections Committee will coordinate the distribution of absentee ballot information to all members "in good standing" after a written request for absentee ballots is received.

2017 language:

- ~~9. Absentee ballots will be sent to members in good standing following a request by mail or electronically to the Elections Committee stating their name, address and email contact information. Requests must be received at least 45 days before the annual meeting.~~
- Absentee ballots will be sent to members in good standing following a request by mail or electronically to the Elections Committee stating their name, address and email contact information. Requests must be received at least 30 days before the annual meeting.
10. The Elections Committee will confirm receipt of absentee ballot requests with requesting members.
 11. Absentee ballots must be returned to the Elections Committee no less than 10 days before the annual meeting unless ballots are distributed at the annual meeting directly to members leaving the conference.
 12. Proxy ballots can only be disseminated by the Elections Committee to members in good standing.
 13. Once proxy ballots are given to members at the annual meeting, they are not allowed to participate in any other balloting process. Proxy ballots issued are not replaceable.
 14. Proxy ballots disseminated by the Elections Committee to members in attendance at the annual conference must be returned sealed to the Elections Committee and placed



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- into the official receptacle provided for that purpose. Ballots must remain sealed until the election votes are being counted.
15. The Elections Committee will provide the "official mail results" which consist of the total of all proxy, absentee and personal ballots. The Elections Committee shall make such results available to the membership at the conclusion of the voting process.
 16. All candidates stating their intention for office are subject to floor nominations or electronically prior to voting in accordance with Robert's Rules of Order as specified within Article V Section 5(a) of the BCOC Bylaws.
 17. Candidates shall be nominated from the floor during prior to the annual conference for an office that remains vacant and/or cannot be filled by a candidate for just cause during the annual BCOC conference.

Section 5: Removal of Officers (Adopted 1993)

- a) The BCOC Executive Board may recommend to the BCOC membership that an officer be removed for failure to perform his/her duties. Such removal requires a two-thirds affirmative vote of both the BCOC Executive Board and or the BCOC membership.
- b) Any officer of the BCOC may resign by filing (timely) written notice with the Executive Board.
- c) Following removal or resignation of an officer, the Chairperson (or Vice Chairperson in the case of the Chairperson's removal or resignation) shall appoint a member to serve the remaining term of the vacated position.

Section 6: Eligibility for Elected Office (Adopted 1993; Amended 2015)

- a) To be eligible for any elected office, a candidate must have been an individual or Retired member in good standing for at least three (3) consecutive years. Service must have been immediately prior to announcement of intention to run for office.



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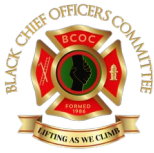
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- b) Those desiring to run for office must be financial and in good standing at least thirty (30) days prior to the start of the Annual Conference. Members must be financially current prior to the start of the Annual Conference in order to be eligible to vote in elections.
- c) The Corresponding/Recording Secretaries shall ensure that candidate profile and position statements are disseminated to all members of the organization no less than 30 days before the annual conference.

2017 language: No corresponding section exists in the existing bylaws.

Section 7: Electronic Voting (Proposed 2026)

- a) The Executive Board authorizes the use of electronic voting for officer elections, bylaw amendments, and any other organizational business. Such authorization shall be communicated to the membership in advance of the voting period.
- b) Electronic voting shall be conducted through a secure, verifiable platform approved by the Executive Board. The platform shall ensure ballot secrecy, prevent duplicate voting, and produce an auditable record of participation and results.
- c) Only members in good standing who are otherwise eligible to vote shall be permitted to participate in electronic voting. The Elections Committee shall be responsible for verifying member eligibility prior to distribution of electronic ballots.
- d) The Chair shall establish the voting window for any electronic vote, which shall be open for no fewer than five (5) days and no more than thirty (30) days, unless otherwise required by these Bylaws or by the nature of the matter being voted upon.
- e) Notice of any electronic vote shall be provided to all eligible members via email or other electronic communication no fewer than five (5) days before the voting window opens. Notice shall include the matter being voted upon, the voting window dates, and instructions for accessing the voting platform.
- f) Results of any electronic vote related to Executive Board positions shall be certified by the Elections Committee and reported to the membership promptly upon the close of the voting window. Electronic vote results shall carry the same force and effect as votes conducted at an in-person meeting. For all other organizational business conducted electronically, results shall be recorded and reported by the Chairperson or designee to the Executive Board and membership at the next available opportunity.



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- g) The quorum and vote threshold requirements otherwise applicable to a given matter under these Bylaws shall apply equally to electronic votes. For officer elections conducted electronically, the provisions of Article V, Sections 2 and 4 shall govern.

ARTICLE VI - EXECUTIVE BOARD (Adopted 1993; Amended 2015, 2017, Proposed 2026)

Section 1: Composition (Adopted 1993)

The Executive Board shall be composed of the BCOC officers [in good standing](#).

Section 2: Functions and Authority (Adopted 1993; Amended 2015)

- a) The Executive Board shall conduct the business affairs of the BCOC and set the agenda for BCOC meetings. The Executive Board shall meet, prior to the meeting, to prepare the agenda whenever possible.
- b) The Executive Board shall be authorized to initiate the removal of a BCOC officer.
- c) The Executive Board shall recommend the level of dues required by each BCOC member or member category. Effectuation of dues level shall be approved by two-thirds of the members assembled at the annual conference.
- d) The fiscal year of the BCOC shall end on December 31. The change in fiscal year is effective December 31, 2015.



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- e) A transition period shall occur between the incoming and the outgoing boards and shall be effective for a thirty (30) day interim after the close of the annual meeting. Outgoing board members shall remain functionally responsible for their respective duties. The incoming board members shall assume full duties of their respective offices at the conclusion of the Transition Period. Furthermore, during this transition period, all decisions pertaining to any new affairs must be discussed at a joint board meeting. However, the outgoing board shall not be involved in decisions pertaining to events scheduled to occur after the transition period is complete. The outgoing board members shall submit a transition report.
- f) The Chair may initiate an electronic vote of the Executive Board on matters that are significant in nature and require urgent action that cannot reasonably be deferred to the next scheduled board meeting. Such votes may be conducted by email, secure electronic platform, or other verifiable electronic means designated by the Chairperson, and shall not require a formal motion. A majority of the seated Executive Board members must participate for the vote to be valid. Results shall be recorded in the minutes of the next regular board meeting. The Chairperson shall provide all board members with a clear description of the matter, the proposed action, and a reasonable response deadline of no fewer than forty-eight (48) hours. Any action taken under this provision shall be reported to the full membership at the next regular or annual meeting.

2017 language: Section 3. Executive Coordinator - The Executive Board shall appoint **an Executive Coordinator, who shall perform such duties and responsibilities as prescribed by the Executive Board.**

Section 3: Executive Coordinator (Amended 2017; Proposed 2026)

- a) The Executive Board shall appoint an Executive Coordinator to assist with administrative and operational functions of the organization. The duties and responsibilities of the Executive Coordinator shall be prescribed by the Chairperson.
- b) The Executive Coordinator shall operate under the direction of the Chairperson and support coordination of meetings, communications to the Executive Board, conferences, and organizational initiatives as directed by the Chairperson.
- c) The Executive Coordinator shall not possess voting authority unless separately elected to an officer position.



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- d) The Executive Coordinator shall provide periodic administrative and operational updates to the Chairperson, who shall relay relevant information to the Executive Board as appropriate.
- e) The Chairperson may establish written policies outlining the responsibilities, scope of work, and reporting structure for the Executive Coordinator.

ARTICLE VII - ATTIRE AND MEETING PROTOCOLS (Adopted 1993)

- a) There shall be an annual meeting, training conference/symposium.
- b) The dress shall be at least sports coat, business attire or department Class A uniform.
- c) ~~The Sergeant-at-Arms, who shall be appointed by the Chairman at the beginning of the annual meeting, shall be stationed at the door(s). They shall admit only those persons who are in good standing with the BCOC and have registered for the meeting.~~

ARTICLE VIII - CONDUCT OF MEMBERS (Adopted 1993)

- a) Members must be loyal, respectful, helpful and diligent in assisting all members of the organization.
- b) Members found to be disloyal, disrespectful, and harmful and/or spread false rumors against brothers and sisters of this organization may be expelled from the BCOC by majority vote.

ARTICLE IX - CONDUCT OF MEETINGS (Adopted 1993; Proposed 2026)

- a) **Rules of Order:** The presiding officer shall preserve order and decorum and shall take no part in debates while presiding. All questions of order shall be subject to an appeal to the conference, and upon such an appeal the vote shall be taken without debate. The



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presiding officer may state the reasons for the decision given and shall put the question as follows, "Shall the decision of the chair be sustained?" A two-thirds majority of those present and voting shall be necessary to reverse the decision of the chair.

- b) **Speaking:** Every member when speaking or offering a motion shall rise, state his or her name, their City and State and respectfully address the presiding officer, and when finished speaking shall at once resume his or her seat.
- c) **Presiding Officer Duties:** When two (2) or more members rise to speak at the same time, the presiding officer shall decide who is entitled to the floor.
- d) **Point of Order:** A member called to order shall immediately cease speaking and resume his or her seat until the point of order in question has been decided, when he or she shall again be entitled to the floor.
- e) **Calling Questions:** A motion to take the previous question shall always be in order except when a member is in possession of the floor, and must be put forward without debate and if supported by a majority vote of those voting, the motion shall be declared carried and no further debate or amendments shall be in order until the main question shall be decided.
- f) **Motions to Adjourn:** A motion to adjourn shall always be in order, except when a member is in possession of the floor or a vote is being taken or it has been decided that a vote shall now be taken. A motion to adjourn is not debatable, but a motion to adjourn to a given time is open to debate.
- g) **Questions without Provision:** The rules contained in the current edition of Robert's Rules of Order shall provide guidance for the organization in all cases to which they are applicable and in which they are not inconsistent with this constitution and by-laws and any special rules of order the organization may adopt.
- h) **Chair Discretion on Motions:** The presiding officer may decline to entertain a motion that is dilatory, frivolous, or manifestly designed to obstruct the orderly conduct of business. The presiding officer may also decline to entertain a motion that: (i) is substantially identical to a motion already defeated at the same meeting; (ii) conflicts with an existing standing rule, policy, or resolution of the Executive Board that has not been rescinded; or (iii) would require action that is outside the authority of the organization or its officers as defined by these bylaws. When the presiding officer declines to entertain a motion, the officer shall briefly state the reason for the ruling. Any



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such ruling is subject to appeal consistent with Article IX, Section (a). The Parliamentarian shall advise the presiding officer on all rulings made under this section.

2017 language: ~~1. No amendment to the By-Laws shall be made except when notice of such Amendment has been presented at least twenty-four (24) hours prior to action, and a two-thirds vote of the members present shall be required to adopt such amendment.~~

ARTICLE X - AMENDMENT TO THE BY-LAWS (Adopted 1993; Proposed 2026)

1. No amendment to the By-Laws shall be made except when notice of such Amendment has been presented at least twenty-four (24) hours prior to action, whether at an in-person membership meeting or by electronic vote conducted pursuant to Article V, Section 7.
2. A two-thirds ($\frac{2}{3}$) affirmative vote of eligible members participating shall be required to adopt such amendment, whether voting is conducted in person or electronically.
Members must be in good standing to vote on any bylaw amendment or position. When a bylaw amendment vote is conducted electronically, the Chair shall certify the results and report them to the full membership no later than seven (7) days following the close of the voting window.
3. Certified results shall carry the same legal force and effect as amendments adopted at an in-person membership meeting. The Recording Secretary shall record all amendment votes in the official minutes of the organization.
2. All amendments, alterations or revisions of any part of the By-Laws shall take effect upon their adoption by the members, unless otherwise so specified.



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ARTICLE XI - DISTRIBUTION OF ASSETS AND PROPERTIES (Adopted 1993)

1. The BCOC is organized exclusively for charitable, religious, educational and scientific purposes, including, for such purposes as, the making of distributions to Organizations that qualify as exempt organizations under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, or corresponding section of any federal tax code.
2. No part of the net earnings of the BCOC shall inure to the benefit of, or be distributable to its members, trustees, officers, or other private persons, except that the BCOC shall be authorized and empowered to pay reasonable compensation for services rendered and to make payments and distributions in furtherance of the purposes set forth in the purpose clause hereof. No substantial part of the activities of the BCOC shall be carrying on of propaganda, or otherwise attempting to influence legislation, and they shall not participate in, or intervene in (including the publishing or distribution of statements) any political campaign on behalf of any candidate for public office.
3. Notwithstanding any other provisions of this document, the BCOC shall not carry on any other activities not permitted to be carried on by an organization exempt from Federal income tax under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, or corresponding section of any future federal tax code, or by an organization, contributions to which are deductible under section 170(c)(2) of the Internal Revenue Code, or corresponding section of any future federal tax code.
4. Upon the dissolution of the BCOC, assets shall be distributed for one or more exempt purposes within the meaning of section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, or corresponding section of any future federal tax code, or shall be distributed to the federal



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government, or to a state or local government, for a public purpose. Any such assets not disposed of shall be disposed of by the Court of Common Pleas of the county in which the principal office of the BCOC is then located, exclusively for such purposes or to such organization or organizations, as said Court shall determine, which are organized and operated exclusively for such purposes.

2017 language: No corresponding Article XII organizational policies article exists in the 2017 bylaws.

ARTICLE XII - ORGANIZATIONAL POLICIES (new)

Section 1. Records Retention and Destruction Policy

In all matters relating to the retention, preservation, and destruction of organizational records, the BCOC shall follow the Records Retention and Destruction Policy and Procedure, attached as Exhibit I and incorporated into these bylaws by reference.

Section 2. Whistleblower Protection Policy

The BCOC shall follow the Whistleblower Protection Policy, attached as Exhibit II and incorporated into these bylaws by reference, in any instance in which an Executive Board member, officer, appointed official, employee, contractor, volunteer, or other person acting on behalf of the BCOC reports a suspected violation of law, policy, fraud, misuse of organizational assets, or other improper conduct.

Section 3. Conflict of Interest Policy and Procedures

The BCOC shall maintain a separate Conflict of Interest Policy and Procedures document, attached as Exhibit III and incorporated into these bylaws by reference. Exhibit III shall serve as a supplement to these bylaws and shall govern the identification, disclosure, review, management, and documentation of actual, potential, or perceived



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conflicts of interest involving Executive Board members, officers, appointed officials, employees, contractors, volunteers, and other persons acting on behalf of the BCOC. All persons covered by this section shall comply with Exhibit III, including all disclosure, recusal, confidentiality, and documentation requirements set forth therein. The Conflict of Interest Policy and Procedures is intended to supplement, and not replace, any applicable federal, state, or local law governing conflicts of interest for nonprofit organizations.

Every elected or appointed member of the Executive Board shall complete and submit a Conflict-of-Interest Disclosure Form within thirty (30) days of assuming office, and annually thereafter by January 31. Such disclosure forms shall be maintained with the official records of the organization by the Recording Secretary, or by such other records custodian as may be designated by the Executive Board.

The Conflict-of-Interest Disclosure Form shall be maintained as Exhibit IV and incorporated into these bylaws by reference.

Administrative updates to Exhibit III and Exhibit IV may be approved by the Executive Board as necessary to maintain compliance with applicable law and sound governance practices, provided such updates do not conflict with these bylaws. Any substantive revision affecting member rights, officer accountability, voting authority, or disciplinary standards shall require approval in accordance with the bylaw amendment process.

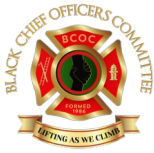
Section 4. Annual Returns Policy

The Executive Board shall review the BCOC's annual filing with the Internal Revenue Service prior to submission of the organization's annual tax return or informational return.

2017 language: No corresponding Code of Ethics section appeared in the 2017 bylaws.

Section 5. Code of Ethics

The BCOC shall maintain a separate Code of Ethics, attached as Exhibit V and incorporated into these bylaws by reference. Exhibit V shall apply to members, officers,



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Executive Board members, appointed officials, employees, contractors, volunteers, and other persons acting on behalf of the BCOC. The Code of Ethics is intended to promote integrity, professionalism, accountability, respect, stewardship, and public trust in all activities conducted in the name of or on behalf of the BCOC.

2017 language: No corresponding Article XIII appointed non-voting positions article exists in the 2017 bylaws.

ARTICLE XIII — APPOINTED NON-VOTING POSITIONS (Proposed 2026)

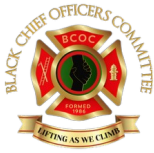
By-laws initially adopted February 6, 1993

- Amendments prepared for adoption February 2000
- Amended January 24, 2005
- Amended February 11, 2006
- Amended March 2, 2007
- Amended February 13, 2010
- Amended February 15, 2017

Proposed Amendments - Open Treasurer Eligibility, Electronic Financial Reporting, Centralized Financial Repository, Electronic Voting, Executive Coordinator Revisions, Appointed Non-Voting Positions (Article XIII), Organizational Policies (Article XII) (2026), Code of Ethics (Article XII / Exhibit V)

Chair

Date



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BLACK CHIEF OFFICERS COMMITTEE

Vice-Chair

Date

Corresponding Secretary

Date

Financial Secretary

Date

Parliamentarian

Date

Treasurer

Date

2017 language: The 2017 bylaws did not include these attached exhibits in this form.

EXHIBITS

Exhibit I (proposed 2026)

Records Retention and Destruction Policy and Procedure

Subject: Records Retention and Destruction Policy and Procedure

Objective: To establish a consistent framework for the creation, retention, storage, protection, retrieval, and lawful destruction of BCOC records.

Purpose: The purpose of this Policy is to ensure that the Black Chief Officers Committee ("BCOC") maintains complete and accurate records, preserves documents necessary for legal, financial, governance, and operational purposes, and disposes of records in an orderly manner consistent with applicable law and sound nonprofit governance practices.

Section 1. Scope and Applicability



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BLACK CHIEF OFFICERS COMMITTEE

This Policy applies to all Executive Board members, officers, appointed officials, committee members, employees, contractors, volunteers, and any other persons acting on behalf of the BCOC who create, receive, store, or manage organizational records in paper or electronic form.

Section 2. Definition of Organizational Records

Organizational records include, but are not limited to, governing documents, minutes, agendas, financial records, tax filings, audit materials, contracts, insurance records, membership rosters, conference records, committee reports, correspondence, grants, publications, website and social media archives, and other records created or maintained in connection with BCOC business.

Section 3. Ownership and Custody of Records

All organizational records are the property of the BCOC and shall be maintained in the custody of the appropriate officer or designee. Official governance records shall be maintained by the Recording Secretary unless otherwise assigned by the Executive Board. Official financial records shall be maintained by the Treasurer, subject to access and oversight requirements established by the Bylaws and Board policy.

Section 4. Retention Standards

The BCOC shall retain records for such periods as are necessary to satisfy legal, fiscal, historical, administrative, and operational requirements.

1). Records of permanent value, including the Articles of Incorporation, Bylaws, IRS determination letters, annual reports, annual conference minutes, Executive Board minutes, tax returns, audit reports, and intellectual property registrations, shall be retained permanently.

The following records should generally be retained for at least seven (7) years unless a longer period is required by law, contract, audit, litigation hold, or Board direction: bank statements, general ledgers, supporting accounting documentation, invoices, receipts,



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contracts after expiration, payroll and vendor records, insurance records after expiration, and conference financial files.

Routine correspondence, drafts, duplicate copies, logistical planning documents, and transitory administrative materials may be destroyed when no longer needed, provided that no litigation hold, audit requirement, public inquiry, or Board directive requires longer retention.

Section 5. Storage and Protection

Records shall be stored in a manner reasonably designed to protect confidentiality, integrity, accessibility, and continuity of operations. Electronic records should, when feasible, be stored in a centralized cloud-based or other secure repository approved by the Executive Board, with appropriate access controls, backup procedures, and succession planning for turnover of officers.

Section 6. Destruction of Records

When the applicable retention period has expired, records may be destroyed in the ordinary course of business, provided that destruction is carried out securely and, in a manner, appropriate to the sensitivity of the information. Paper records containing confidential or financial information shall be shredded or otherwise rendered unreadable. Electronic records shall be deleted in a manner reasonably intended to prevent unauthorized recovery.

Section 7. Litigation Hold and Suspension of Destruction

If the BCOC becomes aware of pending or reasonably anticipated litigation, audit, investigation, subpoena, claim, or other matter requiring preservation of records, all ordinary destruction of relevant records shall be suspended immediately. The



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BLACK CHIEF OFFICERS COMMITTEE

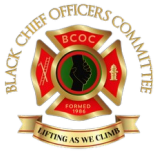
Chairperson, in consultation with legal counsel when appropriate, may issue a litigation hold directing the preservation of specified categories of records until further notice.

Section 8. Responsibility and Compliance

Each person covered by this Policy is responsible for complying with it and for preserving records within his or her custody that relate to BCOC business. Knowingly destroying, altering, concealing, or removing records in violation of this Policy or a litigation hold may result in disciplinary action and any other corrective action authorized by the Bylaws or applicable law.

Section 9. Review and Updates

The Executive Board may review and administratively update this Policy from time to time to reflect operational needs, technology changes, or legal developments, provided such updates do not conflict with the Bylaws. Material changes may be incorporated into the exhibit record maintained with the official BCOC governance documents.



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Exhibit II (proposed 2026)

Whistleblower Protection Policy

Subject: Whistleblower Protection Policy

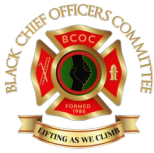
Objective: To provide a clear process for reporting suspected misconduct and to protect good-faith reporters from retaliation.

Purpose: The purpose of this Policy is to encourage the prompt reporting of suspected violations of law, financial impropriety, misuse of organizational assets, fraud, ethical breaches, policy violations, or other improper conduct affecting the Black Chief Officers Committee ("BCOC"), while protecting persons who make good-faith reports from retaliation.

Section 1. Scope and Applicability

This Policy applies to Executive Board members, officers, appointed officials, committee members, employees, contractors, volunteers, members acting in an official capacity, and any other person acting on behalf of the BCOC.

Section 2. Reportable Concerns



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Reportable concerns include, but are not limited to, suspected fraud, embezzlement, theft, falsification of records, financial mismanagement, misuse of BCOC funds or property, conflicts of interest, violations of the Bylaws, harassment or discrimination connected to BCOC operations, retaliation, or any conduct reasonably believed to be unlawful or unethical.

Section 3. Good-Faith Reporting

A report is made in good faith when the reporting person reasonably believes that the information disclosed indicates improper conduct, even if an investigation later determines that no violation occurred. A person who knowingly makes a false report or acts with malicious intent may be subject to appropriate corrective action.

Section 4. Reporting Procedure

Concerns should be reported as soon as practicable to the Chairperson, Vice Chairperson, Recording Secretary, or other officer designated by the Executive Board. If the concern involves the Chairperson, it should be reported to the Vice Chairperson or another disinterested member of the Executive Board. If the concern involves multiple officers or the entire Executive Board, the matter may be referred to independent legal counsel, an external investigator, or a special committee authorized by the Executive Board or membership, as appropriate.

Section 5. Confidentiality

Reports shall be handled as confidentially as reasonably possible, consistent with the need to conduct a fair review, protect due process, comply with legal obligations, and take corrective action where warranted.

Section 6. Non-Retaliation

No person covered by this Policy who makes a good-faith report, participates in an inquiry, or assists in an investigation shall be subject to retaliation, intimidation, harassment, adverse treatment, or other reprisal because of that protected activity. Any retaliation or attempted retaliation shall itself constitute a violation of this Policy.

Section 7. Review and Investigation



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The Executive Board, or a disinterested committee, officer, or outside investigator designated for that purpose, shall review reports received under this Policy and determine what inquiry, investigation, interim safeguards, or corrective action is appropriate. Any person who is the subject of a report shall be excluded from decision-making regarding the review of that matter except to the extent necessary to provide information or respond to allegations.

Section 8. Corrective Action

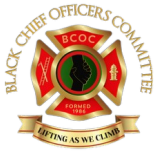
If a report is substantiated, the BCOC may take such corrective action as it deems appropriate under the circumstances, including policy changes, internal controls, training, removal from appointed duties, recommendation of removal from elected office, referral to law enforcement, or other remedial action consistent with the Bylaws and applicable law.

Section 9. Recordkeeping

Reports and related investigative materials shall be documented and maintained in a secure manner by the Recording Secretary or other designated custodian, subject to any confidentiality restrictions, legal holds, or privilege considerations.

Section 10. Review and Updates

The Executive Board may review and administratively update this Policy from time to time to reflect legal developments and governance best practices, provided such updates do not conflict with the Bylaws.



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Exhibit III (proposed 2026)

Conflict of Interest Policy and Procedures

Objective: To ensure that when actual, potential, or perceived conflicts of interest arise, the organization has a clear process through which the affected individual will advise the governing body of all relevant facts concerning the situation.

Purpose: The purpose of this Conflict of Interest Policy (the "Policy") is to protect the interests of the Black Chief Officers Committee ("BCOC") when it is contemplating entering into a transaction or arrangement that might benefit, or appear to benefit, the private interest of any current or former Executive Board member, officer, appointed official, employee, contractor, volunteer, or related party, or result in a possible excess benefit transaction. The BCOC is organized to serve the public interest, and each person acting on behalf of the BCOC must exercise sound judgment to maintain and further the public's trust and confidence in the organization.

Section 1. Scope and General Principles

1. This Policy establishes guidelines, procedures, and requirements for identifying conflicts of interest, disclosing them promptly, reviewing them fairly, managing them appropriately, and documenting the actions taken.



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2. This Policy applies to the Executive Board, officers, appointed officials, committee members, employees, contractors, volunteers, and any other person acting on behalf of the BCOC.
3. This Policy is intended to supplement, and not replace, any applicable federal, state, or local laws governing conflicts of interest applicable to nonprofit and charitable organizations.
4. Questions regarding this Policy shall be directed to the Chairperson, or if the matter involves the Chairperson, to the Vice Chairperson or another disinterested officer designated by the Executive Board.

Section 2. Definitions

1. "Conflict of Interest" means a situation in which, in the judgment of the disinterested decision-makers of the BCOC, an individual's outside interests, relationships, or activities interfere with, compete with, or could reasonably appear to interfere with the best interests of the BCOC.
2. "Covered Interest" includes a direct or indirect ownership interest, investment interest, compensation arrangement, fiduciary duty, legal commitment, or other material financial, personal, professional, or relational interest in an entity or matter with which the BCOC has, or is negotiating, a transaction or arrangement.
3. "Interested Person" means any person covered by this Policy who has a direct or indirect Covered Interest.
4. "Related Party" includes a spouse, domestic partner, ancestor, sibling, half-sibling, child, adopted child, grandchild, great-grandchild, the spouse or domestic partner of any such person, and any entity, trust, partnership, or professional corporation in which the Interested Person or such relatives hold a material ownership, beneficial, management, or financial interest.
5. "Excess Benefit Transaction" means a transaction in which an economic benefit is provided by the BCOC, directly or indirectly, to or for the use of a disqualified person and the value of the economic benefit provided exceeds the value of the consideration received by the BCOC.



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Section 3. Duty to Disclose

1. An Interested Person must disclose the existence of any actual, potential, or perceived Conflict of Interest as soon as the person becomes aware of it and, whenever possible, before the BCOC enters into the transaction or arrangement giving rise to the matter.
2. If the Interested Person is an Executive Board member or officer, the disclosure shall be made to the Executive Board or to another disinterested officer. If the Interested Person is not on the Executive Board, the disclosure shall be made to the person's supervisor, committee chair, or designated officer, who shall in turn notify the appropriate governing authority.
3. The Interested Person shall be given an opportunity to disclose all material facts relating to the matter under review.

Section 4. Determining Whether a Conflict Exists

1. After disclosure of the relevant facts, the disinterested members of the Executive Board, committee, or other authorized decision-making body shall determine by majority vote whether a Conflict of Interest exists.
2. After presenting the relevant facts, the Interested Person shall leave the meeting during discussion and vote on the matter, unless asked to remain temporarily for questions.
3. A determination that a Conflict of Interest exists does not automatically prohibit the transaction or arrangement, but it requires the BCOC to apply the procedures in this Policy before any approval is granted.

Section 5. Procedures for Addressing a Conflict of Interest

1. The Interested Person may make a presentation, but shall not attempt to influence the deliberations or vote after presenting the relevant facts.
2. The Chairperson, or other presiding disinterested officer, may appoint a disinterested person or committee to gather additional information, obtain comparability data, or evaluate alternatives to the proposed transaction or arrangement.
3. After exercising due diligence, the disinterested decision-makers shall determine whether the BCOC can obtain a more advantageous arrangement that does not give rise to a conflict.



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4. If a more advantageous arrangement is not reasonably possible, the disinterested decision-makers may approve the transaction or arrangement only if they determine that it is fair, reasonable, in the best interests of the BCOC, and consistent with the BCOC's mission and fiduciary obligations.

Section 6. Violations of this Policy

1. If the BCOC has reasonable cause to believe that an Interested Person failed to disclose a conflict, the person shall be informed of the basis for that belief and given an opportunity to explain.
2. If, after review, the BCOC determines that the person failed to disclose a conflict, it may take appropriate corrective or disciplinary action consistent with the Bylaws, this Policy, and applicable law.
3. Suspected failures to disclose may also be reported under the BCOC Whistleblower Protection Policy.

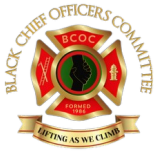
Section 7. Confidentiality

The BCOC shall maintain confidentiality regarding disclosures and related deliberations to the extent reasonably possible, consistent with the need for fair review, organizational transparency, legal compliance, and appropriate documentation.

Section 8. Records of Proceedings

The minutes of any meeting in which a conflict matter is discussed shall, at a minimum, reflect: the name of the Interested Person; the nature of the disclosed interest; whether the Interested Person was present during any portion of the discussion; the determination made as to whether a conflict existed; the names of those participating in the discussion; any alternatives considered; and the vote or final disposition of the matter.

Section 9. Compensation



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Any voting member of the Executive Board or of a committee whose jurisdiction includes compensation matters and who receives compensation, directly or indirectly, from the BCOC for services shall not vote on matters pertaining to that person's compensation, although the person may provide factual information when requested.

Section 10. Annual Statements and Disclosure Form

Every elected or appointed Executive Board member shall annually complete and sign the BCOC Conflict-of-Interest Disclosure Form and shall also disclose any newly arising conflicts as they occur. Other persons covered by this Policy may be required to complete disclosures when directed by the Executive Board or when circumstances warrant.

Section 11. Periodic Review and Use of Outside Advisors

The BCOC may conduct periodic reviews of transactions, compensation arrangements, partnerships, and governance practices to ensure continued compliance with this Policy and the organization's charitable purposes. The BCOC may use legal counsel, accounting professionals, or other outside advisors; however, the use of outside experts does not relieve the Executive Board of its fiduciary responsibilities.

Section 12. Acknowledgement

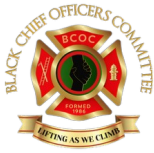
I acknowledge that I have received, read, understand, and agree to comply with this Conflict-of-Interest Policy and Procedures.

Signature: _____

Printed Name: _____

Title/Role: _____

Date: _____



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Conflict-of-Interest Disclosure Form

Name: _____

Title/Role: _____

Date: _____

1. I have received a copy of the BCOC Conflict of Interest Policy and Procedures.
2. I have read and understand the Policy.
3. I agree to comply with the Policy.
4. To the best of my knowledge, I have the following actual, potential, or perceived conflicts of interest to disclose:

5. If no conflicts are presently known, I certify that I have no conflicts of interest to report at this time, other than those disclosed above.
6. I understand that I have an ongoing duty to promptly disclose any conflict of interest that arises after submission of this form.

Signature: _____



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BLACK CHIEF OFFICERS COMMITTEE

Exhibit V (Voted on in 2025)

Committee Code of Ethics

The Black Chief Officers Committee (BCOC) primarily represents current and aspiring Black executives in the all-hazards response community. Trust is a staple of our organization. To preserve the continuing integrity of the BCOC, the highest standards of ethical conduct shall be always maintained.

The purpose of this Professional Code of Ethics is to establish standards that encourage members to promote a culture of ethical integrity and high professionalism in our field. This Code is intended to reduce and prevent situations that could result in embarrassment, diminished credibility, or loss of support for an organization that has historically been highly respected. All members of the BCOC share a responsibility to project professionalism, integrity, compassion, loyalty, and honesty in all that they do.

Members shall:

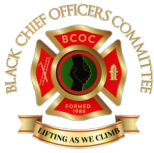
- 1) Always conduct themselves, on and off duty, in a manner that reflects positively on themselves, their families, and the BCOC.
- 2) Accept responsibility for their actions and for the consequences of those actions.
- 3) Support fairness and the value of diverse thoughts and opinions.
- 4) Avoid situations that would adversely affect the credibility or public perception of the BCOC.
- 5) Be truthful and honest at all times and report instances of cheating or other dishonest or unethical conduct that compromise the integrity of the BCOC.
- 6) Conduct personal affairs in a manner that does not improperly influence the performance of their duties or bring discredit to the BCOC.
- 7) Be respectful and mindful of each member's safety and welfare.
- 8) Recognize that they serve in positions of public trust that require stewardship in the honest and efficient use of human resources, fiscal resources, and all publicly owned or entrusted resources, and ensure such resources are protected from misuse and theft.



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- 9) Exercise professionalism, competence, respect, and loyalty in the performance of their duties and use information, confidential or otherwise, gained by virtue of their positions only to benefit those they are entrusted to serve.
- 10) Avoid financial investments, outside employment, outside business interests, or activities that conflict with, are enhanced by, or appear to be influenced by their official positions.
- 11) Never propose or accept personal rewards, special privileges, benefits, advancement, honors, or gifts that may create a conflict of interest, or the appearance of a conflict of interest.
- 12) Never discriminate on the basis of race, religion, color, creed, age, marital status, national origin, ancestry, gender, sexual orientation, medical condition, or disability.
- 13) Never harass, intimidate, threaten, or bully fellow members of the BCOC, the fire service, or the public, and report the actions of others who engage in such behavior.
- 14) Comply with all applicable laws and campaign rules when supporting political candidates and engaging in political activities.
- 15) Refrain from endorsing commercial products through quotations, photographs, testimonials, or similar means for personal gain.
- 16) Use social networking, electronic communications, and other media technologies responsibly in a manner that does not discredit, dishonor, or embarrass the BCOC, and understand that failure to resolve or report inappropriate use of such media may be treated as condoning such behavior.



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Board Members and Officers

All officers and Executive Board members of the BCOC shall always exercise the highest ethical standards of conduct and practice fundamental honesty.

Officers and Executive Board members shall not:

- 1) Deceive, defraud, or mislead BCOC members, officers, or those with whom the BCOC has business or other relationships.
- 2) Misrepresent the BCOC in any negotiation, dealing, contract, or agreement.
- 3) Divulge or release information relating to the BCOC's plans, mission, or operational records without appropriate approval.
- 4) Obtain a personal advantage or benefit through use of the organization's name.
- 5) Accept individual gifts of any kind in excess of \$50.00 in connection with the individual's relationship with the BCOC.
- 6) Withhold their best efforts in performing their duties to acceptable standards.
- 7) Engage in unethical business practices of any kind.
- 8) Use BCOC property, financial resources, or the services of BCOC members for personal benefit.
- 9) Be convicted of any civil or criminal offense that materially undermines the integrity, credibility, or mission of the BCOC.

Infractions of this Statement of Personal and Professional Standards of Conduct shall be reported directly to any member of the Audit Committee, who may, in that member's judgment, refer the matter to the full Executive Board for review and action consistent with the bylaws and organizational policies of the BCOC.